TAKE-HOME EXERCISES

Setup and exercise overview

Everything you need before you start: how to get your Loom account set up, how we recommend using dictation, and what each of the three exercises asks of you.

We are looking for a window into your raw thinking — not polished production. Read the setup once, then work through the exercises in order.

PART ONE	PART TWO	PART THREE
Loom access	Dictation	The three exercises

PART ONE

Loom access

To streamline video submissions we have a simple Loom workflow, so you can upload videos as part of the interview process. This guide explains how to accept your invite, remove the recording time limit, confirm the desktop app is on the right account, and submit each video to your candidate space.

By the end of setup you should be able to record Loom videos with **unlimited time** (not the 5-minute limit), save them in the **Tribe Interviews** workspace, and add each one to your private space, **C – <Your Name>**.

STEP 1

Accept the Loom invite

1. Look for an email invite to join a Loom workspace (from Tribe or Loom).
2. Click **Accept invitation**.
3. Follow the prompts to sign in or create your Loom account.
4. You should land in the Tribe Interviews Loom workspace library.

CHECKPOINT

You can see **Tribe Interviews** in Loom — the workspace name is visible in the top-left.

STEP 2

Set your default workspace to Tribe Interviews

Critical — this prevents Loom from saving recordings to a personal workspace with a 5-minute cap.

1. Open loom.com/settings/account.
2. Confirm you are viewing settings for the Tribe Interviews workspace — use the workspace selector in the top-left if needed.
3. Go to **Personal settings**, not team or admin settings.
4. Scroll to **Default Workspace** and set it to Tribe Interviews.
5. Click **Save**.

CHECKPOINT

Default Workspace shows Tribe Interviews.

STEP 3

Install or use the Loom desktop app

We recommend the desktop app over the Chrome extension — it is generally more reliable. If you do not have it, install it from Loom's download page. If you already have it, continue to Step 4 to verify the account.

STEP 4

Confirm the desktop app is on the right account

You can be signed into the wrong Loom account in the desktop app even when your browser is correct, so it is worth checking.

CHECK WHO YOU ARE LOGGED IN AS — MAC

1. Open the Loom desktop widget from the menu bar.
2. Click the ellipsis (More) button.
3. Click **Settings**.
4. Go to the **Preferences** tab, the rightmost one.
5. Read the account info showing who you are logged in as.

IF IT IS THE WRONG ACCOUNT

1. In Preferences, click **Sign out** and confirm.
2. In your browser, sign into the Loom account with access to Tribe Interviews.
3. Back in the desktop app, click **Sign in**.
4. A browser tab opens asking about authentication for a new device — click **Yes, this is me**.
5. The app reopens authenticated under the correct account.

CHECKPOINT

The desktop app shows you logged into the correct email account.

STEP 5

Confirm you have unlimited recording time

Once you are logged into the correct account in the desktop app and your default workspace is Tribe Interviews, Loom should show a no-limit time indicator (commonly displayed as a 0:00-style counter).

CHECKPOINT

You do not see a 5-minute limit.

STEP 6

Do a quick test recording

Start a short test recording and finish it — you should land on a page where you can view the new recording.

CHECKPOINT

In the left navigation, confirm you are still in Tribe Interviews.

STEP 7

Submit your recording to your candidate space

A recording only counts as a submission once it is added to your private candidate space.

1. Open the recording you want to submit and click **Share**.
2. In the share modal, find **Spaces**. You will see "All Tribe Interviews" (ignore it) and a private space named **C – <Your Name>**.
3. Select your **C – <Your Name>** space and click **Add**.
4. Set permissions to **Can view**, not edit.
5. Click the final **Share** or **Save** confirmation.

CHECKPOINT

The video now appears in the **C – <Your Name>** space.

Final submission checklist

For each required video:

- ☐ Recorded with Tribe Interviews as the default workspace
- ☐ Video added to the C – <Your Name> space
- ☐ Repeated for every submission video
- ☐ Recording shows no time limit
- ☐ Permissions set as instructed

Common issues

"My recordings are capped at 5 minutes."

Your default workspace is likely personal. Go to loom.com/settings/account → Default Workspace → set Tribe Interviews → Save.

"I can't find my C – <Your Name> space."

You may not have accepted the invite, or you are in the wrong workspace or account. Confirm the workspace in the top-left and the account in the desktop app.

“My video isn't showing up in the right place.”

It may have been recorded under the wrong workspace, or not added to your candidate space. Open the video → Share → add it to C – <Your Name>.

PART TWO

Dictation and async Looms

Most people find their first "talk through it on a recording" experience slightly weird. That is expected. We are not looking for a produced video — we want a window into how you think, reason, and communicate.

WHAT WE OPTIMIZE FOR

- Clear thinking and decision-making — tradeoffs, assumptions, priorities
- Your ability to explain *why* you chose an approach
- How you handle ambiguity and make progress

WHAT WE DO NOT OPTIMIZE FOR

- A flawless presentation
- Perfect wording, pacing, or polished writing
- Studio-quality audio

Recording format

Preferred: screen share, audio, and transcript. When screen sharing, keep the relevant doc open, scroll as you talk so we can follow your trail of thought, and use a simple structure — "here's the situation → here are the options → here's what I'd do and why."

Background noise: life happens. Occasional kids, doorbells, or street noise is completely okay — don't re-record over a momentary interruption. If you can, record somewhere reasonably quiet, speak closer to the mic (headphones help), and do a 5–10 second test clip first. Submit all exercises together once the full take-home is complete, using the link provided in your email.

Tech for dictating to agents

We are big fans of **Superwhisper** or **Wisprflow** as a way to work quickly alongside agents — dictation is quickly becoming the standard at Tribe. If you strongly prefer typing, that is okay; we would still love to hear you reason out loud. We care most about the clarity of your thinking.

TWO AUDIENCES

You are speaking to two audiences and will switch between them constantly: the **person watching the Loom** (thinking out loud — reasoning, tradeoffs, choices) and the **agent you are working with** (directing it to draft and refine artifacts in real time). Say out loud which one you are addressing.

TO THE AGENT

"For the doc: ..." · "Agent: please write this as bullets..." · "Update the handoff doc with..."

TO THE VIEWER

"Now stepping back: here's why I chose this..." · "The core tradeoff is..." · "My assumptions are..."

Speaking to the viewer

Treat it like you are talking with a colleague. Don't over-edit mid-sentence — if you misspeak, restate and move on. Signposts help: "my assumptions are...", "the core tradeoff is...", "the highest-risk part is...", "here's how I'd validate this." Auto-transcripts are useful even with minor errors; if one misses a term or acronym, clarify verbally and keep going.

APPENDIX · OPTIONAL, 10 MINUTES

Practice exercise: agent dictation

If you want to get comfortable talking to an agent first: open your AI assistant of choice, paste in this write-up, and run the prompts below in order — by typing or by voice.

01 · BE EXPLICIT ABOUT FORMAT

"Turn the 'speaking to the viewer' section into 6 crisp bullets. Keep the meaning, make it tighter."

02 · STATE AUDIENCE AND INTENT

"Rewrite the background-noise guidance for a candidate anxious about being judged. Stay reassuring, keep the quiet-place point."

03 · EDIT, DON'T REWRITE

"Keep everything else the same, but add one sentence saying it's okay to submit partial work and follow up later."

04 · ADD STRUCTURE

"Add a short FAQ with three questions: do I need screen share, what if my transcript is messy, what if I stumble? Two to three sentences each."

05 · CONSTRAINT-DRIVEN REVISION

"Make the whole doc 20% shorter without losing key guidance. Keep the two-audience framing and compress the appendix."

06 · CORRECT THE AGENT

"That's not what I meant — keep the reassuring tone, but do not remove the quiet-space recommendation. Please revise."

The muscle memory you are building: stating format, stating audience and intent, editing via instructions instead of rewriting, and re-stating constraints when the agent drifts.

PART THREE

The three exercises

1

ASYNC TECHNICAL LEADERSHIP · DICTATION

A window into how you lead

Pick from a set of modules, each with a handful of questions and a recommended time window. The intent is not a polished essay — it is your raw thinking, and how you reason through tradeoffs, ambiguity, and direction-setting. The exercise brief specifies the module options and recommended timing.

Submission: a Loom recording — ideally screen share plus audio. Audio and transcript alone works great too.

2

ASYNC CLIENT PRIORITIZATION

Parachute in and improve

How you approach a real situation where you inherit an existing system, diagnose it, and extend it to meet product and business goals. This is deliberately not a "design Twitter at massive scale" interview — it is closer to the work we actually do. You get a short packet describing the business context and an existing system, do a pre-read, then use templates to write up your understanding of the problem and the changes you would make.

Submission: a Loom recording plus short written docs.

3

FULL-STACK CODING EXERCISE

Build an AI solution end to end

We would love to see how you develop with AI, how you prioritize, and how you would evolve things post-launch. Record a Loom where you build a system fully end to end, demo it, walk through the architecture at a high level, share what you learned while building, and discuss what you would do next with more time — quality, evals, observability.

Submission: a Loom with screen share and audio, the working app as a zip of your local git repo, a README, and a short decision log (DECISIONS.md).

TIMING

Please complete the exercises within 5 consecutive days.

Submit all exercises at once, once the full take-home is complete, using the link provided in your email.

A couple of meta-notes: we are genuinely looking for your raw thinking, not perfect outputs. If questions come up while you are working through any of this, just reply — happy to clarify.